7.9.4 Stroke

Definition: The sudden death of brain cells due to lack of oxygen caused by blockage of blood flow or rupture of an artery to the brain.

Causes

- Hypertension
- Smoking
- Alcohol
- Diabetes
- Cardiac diseases



Management

- Prevention and treatment of acute complications.
- Rehabilitation to minimise disability.
- Medical intervention to minimise impairment.
- Nursing Intervention (nutrition, skin care, positioning, bladder and bowel care)
- Drug therapy with anti platelet agents and hunting co-coagulants.

7.9.5 Arthritis and Osteoporosis



Definition of Arthritis

It is a painful inflammation and stiffness of the joints. Arthritis simply means inflammation of the joints. The symptoms include pain, swelling and stiffness with limitation of joint movements.

Causes

- Abnormal metabolism
- Genetic inheritance
- Infection
- Systemic lupus erythematosus

Definition of Osteoporosis

Osteoporosis means "porous bones" causing bones to become weak and brittle.

Causes

- Low bone mass
- Calcium and vitamin D deficiency
- Sedentary life style
- Thyroid problems
- Smoking

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